

prompt from **Start > Programs > Accessories > MS-DOS Prompt**. Type the following commands (assuming C:\Windows is where Windows is installed):

```
cd c:\windows\system
copy regsvr32.exe wbem
cd wbem
for %%f in (*.dll) do regsvr32 /s %%f
winmgmt /regserver
exit
```

This will register the WMI components and you should not get the errors henceforth. The Access error could happen due to a number of reasons but is most probably due to a corrupted or inaccessible file. Try repairing the Office XP installation or entirely removing and reinstalling it from **Control Panel > Add/Remove Programs**.

CD-ROM not detected

Q. My system has a 466 MHz Celeron processor with 256 MB RAM. I have a 17 GB hard disk as primary master, a CD-Writer as secondary master and a 48x CD-ROM drive as secondary slave. Once in a while, when I use the Auto Detect HDD option from the BIOS, all the drives are detected and work fine, but later the CD-ROM drive is not available through Windows. Two or three boots later the BIOS fails to detect it, giving an error: 'ATAPI Error, secondary slave incompatible. Press F1 to continue'. The Auto Detect function in the BIOS does not work either. When I asked a technician to look at it, he said that there was a problem with the lens. I got the lens changed, but the problem persists.

Hrishikesh Thite

Via e-mail

A You haven't mentioned what version of Windows you are running. However, there are a few things you can try, assuming that all the jumpers are set according to the instructions on the drives. First, try switching the IDE channels. Set the CD-ROM drive to primary slave, or set the CD-Writer to secondary slave and the CD-ROM drive to secondary master. If this does not help, revert to the current configuration and set the secondary slave as 'None' in the BIOS. Reboot to Windows and see if it detects the drive.

Access denied

Q. I use WinZip and have password-protected certain archives but have forgotten the password to a very important

file. Can it be retrieved by any means?

Deep Choudhury

Via e-mail

A There are some tools to recover passwords from archives, but none of these are free. Some use dictionary-based password recovery techniques (trying various possibilities from a predefined list), others use brute force to crack the password (trying every possible combination



Use Zip Key to recover passwords from zipped archives

of characters). You can try out Zip Key from www.lostpassword.com.

Printer setup

Q. I had an assembled PC running Windows Me and a dot matrix printer TVS-E Novo 130. With this, I was able to change the page setup as I wanted. Now I have bought a Compaq Presario 700 laptop, with Windows XP as the OS. I installed Office XP and the same printer on this laptop. When working with Excel, I am not able to change the page setup to 9x6 inches. It provides me with some odd paper sizes, which are of no use to me. Please help me.

Kamal

Kolkatta

A The available paper sizes are just a function of the printer driver. You can download the latest drivers for the printer from <http://www.tvs-e.com/products/novo130.html>, or try using different dot matrix drivers for the printer from the Windows XP list of printers (**Control Panel > Printers > Add Printer**).

VHS to VCD

Q. I have a Pentium 4 1.6 GHz processor with a 32 MB Riva TNT2 M64 graphics card, a 40 GB hard disk and a Sony 24x10x40x CD-Writer. Can I use my PC for VHS to VCD conversion with a VCR as input? What will I need to do this? What will be the procedure?

Dhande Yogesh

Via e-mail

A Your system is adequate for processing video—all you need is a video capture card. There are several available, such as the ones from PixelView, Adcom and Tekram, all under Rs 3,500. Just install the card, connect it to your VCR and record the video using the bundled software. For converting the movie to VCD, you will have to encode it in MPEG-1 format. Any standard CD burning software will be able to burn this to a VCD.

Internet sharing

Q. We use seven Celeron 700 MHz machines with 64 MB RAM, networked with Cat5 cables and the server has 256 MB RAM with Windows 98 SE. A 56 Kbps external modem from this shares the dial-up Internet connection on the network using ICS (Internet Connection Sharing). The clients do not open Web pages fast enough. Please suggest how I can improve the Internet speed.

Robert Larinawma

Aizawl

A You can't really expect very high speeds on your connection since theoretically, you are sharing a speed of just over 5 Kbps across eight machines. Thus, even if you are indeed getting the full bandwidth from the connection, each machine is getting only over 600 bytes per second, which is very slow. You may want to use a better proxy server such as WinGate (www.wingate.com), by which you can monitor the total bandwidth to know



WinGate can log bandwidth usage when sharing an Internet connection

exactly how much bandwidth you are receiving at different times of the day. If you are getting the full 56 Kbps, there's not much you can do to improve the speed, except add a modem to one of the machines and set it up as a proxy server for half the network.

Failing hard disk

Q. Recently, my Windows did not boot and showed a 'VFAT Initialization Error'. Scandisk fixed some errors and I formatted the hard disk and reinstalled